



Come Help Build a Community Pharmacy in Upala

COSTA RICA

Open TripPCRC1CAN

More than 15 years ago, a group of single mothers received land in a remote area of Upala, Costa Rica. Since then, these women have worked tirelessly to create a better future for their families.

With the support of **Reto Juvenil**, they have developed leadership skills, formed a community association, and worked together to build a stronger and more independent community.

Today, the community has a **primary school, community hall, church, and health center**, as well as access to **running water, electricity, and internet** in the center of the village. This is a community that has accomplished a great deal—but one important need remains.

A Simple Solution to a Serious Problem

A doctor visits the community every two weeks, providing an essential medical service to families who otherwise have limited access to healthcare. However, the health center does not have a dedicated space to store and distribute prescription medications after the doctor's visits.

Families who need their prescribed medicines must travel to the nearest town to collect them. Transportation costs approximately **\$9.75 per trip**, while many women earn only around **\$2 per day** working in pineapple and cassava fields.

For families living on such limited incomes, this transportation cost can be overwhelming. For some, it is simply not possible to make the trip to collect their prescribed medication.

As a result, they may have to remain without the treatment they need and continue suffering from their illness.

For a family struggling to put food on the table, accessing medication can become a heartbreaking choice between **healthcare and food**.



Help Us Build a Community Pharmacy

We want to build a **small pharmacy within the community health center**. The local health center association will be responsible for managing the space and distributing medications to community members after medical visits.

This may be a small room, but its impact can be enormous.

It will mean that mothers will not have to spend a day's wages simply to travel for medicine. It will mean that children and families can receive the treatment they need closer to home. And it will provide the community with a lasting resource that can serve families for many years to come.

We Need You

We are inviting you as volunteers **and donors** to come to Upala, meet this inspiring community, and become part of making this project possible. Your support will help us take the first steps toward building the pharmacy—and your time and energy can help turn an empty space into something that directly improves people's lives.

During the 4-Day Volunteer Experience, You Will:

- Meet the mothers, children, and community leaders.
- Learn about the community's history, achievements, and challenges.
- Participate in the first stages of construction, including site preparation and digging.
- Support educational and community activities.
- Experience authentic rural Costa Rican culture.
- Discover the natural beauty of Upala, including **Río Celeste and the surrounding rainforest**.
- Have the opportunity to extend your trip and explore the beautiful **beaches of Guanacaste**.

Your Four Days Can Make a Lasting Difference